BIKES IN SCHOOLS
School Guide

greater WELLINGTON
REGIONAL COUNCIL
Te Pane Matua Taiao



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Bike in Schools - School Guide

So you have your track… now what?

The bike tracks are built, bikes are assembled, kids have helmets and the dust has settled. Now what? This guide is designed to help your school get the most out of your bike tracks.

Track Management and Bike Maintenance

Classroom Bookings

Online booking systems work well. If the school hasn't already got a system in place, Google calendar is free and easy to use with Google accounts. Try to have each class make a regular (weekly) booking, and allow extra bookings in the free slots. Depending on the size of your school, you may want to have each class use the track every day, or have 2-3 fixed time-slots per class each week.

Principal Kaylene Macnee from Pinehaven School found the following useful:

- A clear timetable with expectations around how often (at a minimum) people will ride
- Being part of the class PE/Fitness programme
- Commitment from teachers and parents to support the programme
- Units of work such as everyone's a road user

No helmet...no ride

Helmets

Ideally each child will have their own, named helmet which is stored in class. Feedback from schools suggests that having a 'helmets on when outside' policy works well, i.e. kids put their helmets on before they leave the classroom and keep them on until they return. This minimises the risk of helmets being dropped, straps tangled or mixed up. *See Appendix 1 for a helmet check and fitting guide.*

Tip:

Colour code (with electrical tape) the four different sized bikes so it is easy for the children to identify the size of the bike that fits them best, or bikes that have the seats adjusted to high, medium or low positions. This saves time and also reduces the amount of seat adjusting required.

See also Appendix 4 for instructions on adjusting seat height.

Basic bike repairs, adjustments, and care

Organising a regular basic bike maintenance session for teachers and parents helpers can be very useful. Especially as the bikes get 'broken in' and kids get used to them. Essential repair skills include:

- Pumping up tyres and fixing punctures/replacing tubes
- Tightening or checking the quick releases, either to adjust seat height or secure wheels
- Putting the chain back on
- Tightening loose bits (reflectors and bells) which can fall off or break
- Tightening up loose or twisted handlebars
- Adjusting brakes
- Minimum/Maximum seat post height - NB. adjusting the seat post beyond the 'maximum height' marking can cause injury to the rider and damage the bike frame.
- Oiling the chain



Bike Maintenance

To get the most out of your bikes, get them checked regularly. Kids can be rough with them, whether or not it is intentional. Brakes loosen up, wheels get out of alignment, spokes break and other bits (bells and reflectors) can break off and leave sharp edges. Getting a bike mechanic in to regularly service the bikes can extend their use by years.

The first check is the most critical – after about 15 hours of riding (only a few weeks!), all the cables will have 'loosened up' and need tightening – particularly the brakes! If you contract mechanics to assemble the bikes, ask them to also come back and check the bikes after a few weeks. Professionals often offer this service for free. If you have volunteer parents or staff assemble the bikes, get a mechanic in to check the bikes before kids use them and again after a few weeks.

Contact your local council, cycling advocates or bike shop to organise a basic bike maintenance course for parents and teachers, or even students.

See also Appendix 3 or
www.bit.do/bike-maintenance

"The bike track opens up a whole vast range of opportunities for the kids. We've got those students who may struggle in class... but are incredibly capable in other areas, so we want to create a workshop where kids can actually be mechanical and apply some skills there and be seen to be succeeding in those areas, which will be really exciting."

Matthew Skilton (Principal, Tawhai School)

Bike monitors

Let kids take responsibility for getting the bikes out of the shed every morning, and putting them away before the bell goes. Select a group of senior students for this prestigious task!

Tip:

Tip: paint lines on the court so that the bikes get set up nicely - not too close, not too far apart. Select somewhere out of the wind if possible.



Photo Credit: Pedal Ready at Holy Cross School Miramar

Bike track checks

Another important job is checking the track in the morning (particularly on a Monday when it may have been subject to use, rain and wind). Check for sticks and other debris, which may create a hazard. Note any spots that are looking worn out. If you have a skills track, check that the seesaw and other structures are working well.

Check with the company/organisation that installs the bike track how often the track will need topping up/grading (if lime) and what signs to look out for that maintenance is required. Also make sure you know who to call and who is responsible for repairs/maintenance to skills track equipment or the pump track.

Bike checks and logbook

Tip:

Use a simple 'code' to indicate a bike is in need of repair – either flip those bikes upside down, or rotate the seat backwards, so students and teachers know not to use it.

Once the children have done a Pedal Ready course, they'll know how to do a basic 'A, B, C, D' bike check (see below). Ensure all children check their bikes before each use. This should only take a minute. You may also choose to enlist some of the senior students to do a bike check on a regular basis. Any faults should be reported in the bike logbook and urgent repairs should be reported to the school office or caretaker.

Take care that seat posts aren't over-extended beyond the 'max insert' marking as this can lead to injury and frames splitting. A certain amount of the seat post needs to be inside the seat tube to hold the riders weight. There should be a mark (sometimes hard to read) on the seat post that shows the maximum distance the seat post can be raised.



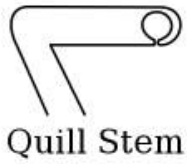
A-B-C-D quick (drop) bike check

A handy quick check to make sure a bike is safe to ride.

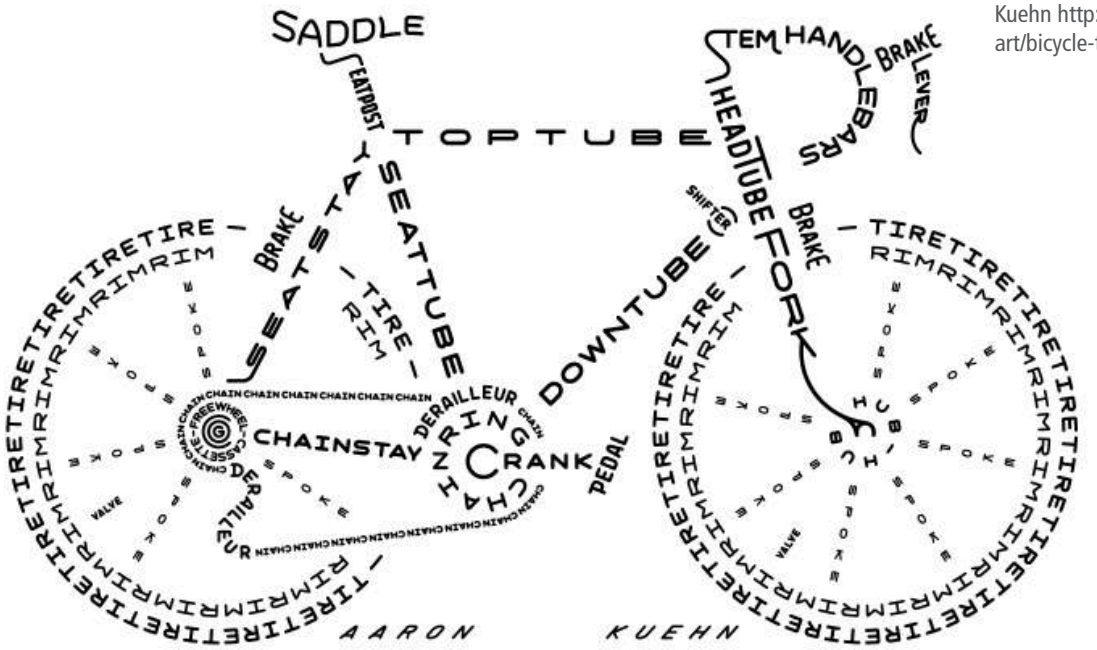
- A is for Air – in the tyres. Also check everything around the wheel looks good, it spins freely and without wobbling, and there are no broken spokes. If an older bike, check the tread on the tyre.
- B is for Brakes – check each brake by wheeling the bike forward and pulling on them one at a time. The front brake should cause the back wheel to lift off the ground when pulled firmly. The back brake will skid and lock up. Brakes are often disconnected when transporting bikes so always check that these are attached and working, that the brake pads are more than 3mm thick and fully touching the rims when on.
- C is for Chain – check the chain has clean oil on it and is rotating freely. The chain should be black or silver and a small amount of oil should come off if you touch it.

- D is for Direction – with the front wheel 'parked' between your legs, try to turn the handlebars firmly - you should not be able to force it to turn. The handlebars should turn with the wheel. If the handlebars turn and the wheel does not, tighten it up using an Allen key (the bolt is often hidden under a plastic cover on top of the head tube).
- Quick is for the quick releases. Check these are all done up correctly and tight. Quick release levers can be found on the wheels and seat post. They should curve in around the seat post or towards the centre of the wheel.
- Drop the bike gently from about 10cm and listen for any unusual rattles. Remove or tighten where required.

See also the Bikewise Safety Check poster in Appendix 2 and Pedal Ready's Legal Requirements card (Appendix 5).







Bicycle Typogram by Aaron Kuehn http://aaronkuehn.com/art/bicycle-typogram

School Cycling Policies

School Policy for children riding to school

Once children become more confident and interested in riding their bikes, they may want to ride to school. The school can offer parents some guidance on the best approach to this. See the newsletter notice in the Appendix for a sample biking policy.

If there are any areas around the school that cause particular concern (e.g. you may wish children to dismount and walk across the school crossing), highlight these to parents and students. Also, where possible, let them know what action the school is/has taken to address this (e.g. communicating with the local council/School Travel Planner).

The NZTA safety tips for children cycling can be found here: www.bit.do/NZTA-safety-tips

See also Appendix 6 for a Notice to Parents, which the school can send out after students complete Grade 2 cycle skills training and Appendix 7 for the Bikewise guide for Biking to School Safely.

School Policy for use of the track at lunchtimes or after hours

Schools have different policies around lunchtime use. Many schools introduce this when the children show they can ride responsibly with minimal supervision. If lunchtime use is allowed/encouraged, students will need access to their helmets.

Generally schools encourage the use of their bike track after school and in weekends. As the community has often been involved in fundraising efforts, this is a nice way to 'give back' to the community and keep them involved. You may find it is helpful to set the tone by putting up a sign with some rules for using the track.

See also: "Use of the track by the wider community" on page 13.



Getting students riding

How kids can get involved and get the most out of the track. See also 'Curriculum' under Teachers resources and Future Track for other activities.

Cycle skills training

Pedal Ready offers free cycle skills training to schools in the Wellington region. Children start by learning basic cycle skills on the school grounds (grade 1) and senior students may graduate on to learning skills on local roads (grade 2). Book early as they fill up quickly, especially in terms 1 and 4.

www.pedalready.org.nz/schools

Working with beginners

For many children this may be the first time they ride a bike (or ride without training wheels/stabilisers). There's a lot for them to learn; depending on their age and ability, it may be best to break it up in stages. Keep it fun and try not to let them get tired or demotivated. Encourage them to keep going if they fall.

Bikewise have a good guide on how to teach an individual child to ride on the Oh Baby website. Here's a brief summary, but the article is well worth a read.

www.bit.do/learn-to-ride

Set up the child's bike correctly – while learning they should be able to reach the ground with both feet flat and reach the hand brake(s) comfortably.

1. Getting on and off your bike – the child should apply the brakes and lean the bike towards them. Apply the brakes when getting off too.
2. Scooting – Before they start pedalling, encourage them to scoot the bike with both feet. This helps them get used to the balance, steering and brakes. Aim to have them lifting both feet off the ground for longer and longer periods. If they've used a balance/runner bike, they may already be quite good at this.
3. Starting and stopping – walk along with them, pushing the bike and using the brakes to stop. Use both brakes (either both hands, or a hand and back pedal brake). Encourage them to start with a "strong push" to get moving – keeping your balance while riding slowly is much harder.
4. Balance and vision – Remind them to look where they're going; "Look where you go – go where you look".
5. Pedalling work – Use the 'pedal ready' position as much as possible – this is when one of the pedals (right side if possible) is at 2 o'clock. This lets them gain momentum quickly, and helps keep their balance. Going slow is much harder. Hold onto the handlebars (or under the seat) at first to help them keep their balance. As they get more confident, loosen your hold and eventually let go. Talk to them about what you're doing so they

Tip:

While a nice grassy field may be more appealing to a nervous child, it will be much harder work for them. Try to find a smooth court or path, ideally with a gentle downhill gradient to help get them moving.

aren't caught off guard. If possible find a court or path with a gentle downhill gradient to help them get started. Once they get the hang of riding by themselves, introduce some gentle turns and keep practicing stopping using both brakes.



The "Pedal Ready position"

Bikewise "Learn to ride a bike" guide: www.bit.do/learn-to-ride

The following guidelines from SusTrans (UK) may also be useful resources:

Cycling with Kids guides: www.bit.do/sustrans

Learn to Cycle videos: www.bit.do/sustrans-videos

Working with groups of beginners

If you have a group of beginners, get the whole group to practice scooting without pedals until they get their balance and steering. Encourage them to keep looking where they want to go and to get the bike moving (keeping your balance while going slow is much harder!).

Show them all how the brakes work and explain that using two brakes (both hands, or a hand and foot brake) is best. Get them used to 'covering' their brakes with at least two fingers of each hand.

As they are ready, they will start pedalling. Use the tips covered above. You can only help one child directly at a time, but the other children can 'assist' you. They can help the child riding to keep looking up, by calling out their name or dancing around. Have the children take turns and encourage each other. Occasionally, one child might be quite close to 'getting it' so you can focus on them for a bit while asking the other children to assist or go back to scooting their bikes. If children are getting tired, don't push them. The most important thing is that they enjoy it! They may not all get there in the first session, but they will get there eventually.

No Exceptions Policy

Read more about the Halberg Disability Sport Foundations mission to enable all New Zealanders to participate in sport and recreation.

They can provide you with assistance and advice. The Halberg Disability Sport Foundation have also provided special purpose bikes for students at a number of Bike in Schools schools. Also be sure to communicate any special requirements to cycle skills providers before the day, so that they can bring extra instructors if required.

www.sportwellington.org.nz/disability-inclusion/

See also: "Biking to school" on page 12 and Appendix 7, or "Other activities" (pages. 15-17)



Photo credit: Pedal Ready at West Park School

Parents and the Community

What parents need to know about kids biking, and getting the most out of the bike track.

Biking to school

Note:

riding on the footpath is only allowed if the bike wheels are under a certain size (wheel diameter up to 355mm) or the cyclist is delivering mail/newspapers. While it may feel safer to encourage your child to ride on the footpath, don't assume it is safer because of the added driveway hazards, i.e. every driveway is a potential point of conflict, and drivers exiting driveways may not expect a fast moving cyclist on the footpath.

Once children are confident on their bikes and have completed cycle skills training, they may be keen to bike to school. Younger children should always be accompanied by an adult. Prepare older children by riding the route with them and discussing what to do if anything unexpected happens. Children should always wear a helmet and follow the road rules.

The following guidelines from NZTA and Bikewise may also be useful resources:

www.bit.do/bike-safety

www.bit.do/road-rules

www.bit.do/safety-tips

www.bit.do/road-code

See also: the "School Cycling Policies" on page 8 and the Bikewise guide to Biking to School Safely in Appendix 7.

'Bike Skills 101' - cycle skills for adults

This Pedal Ready course covers bike and helmet checks, basic handling skills and an introduction to riding on the road. There is also workplace and tertiary student training available.

www.pedalready.org.nz/adults/

'Parent and child courses' - cycle skills for families

If you're keen to become more confident and safe while riding with your children, you can enrol for a Pedal Ready 'parent and child course'. These can be held for one family at a time, but groups can be arranged. Email info@pedalready.org.nz to book.

www.pedalready.org.nz/parents/booking-information/

Volunteering

There are many ways you can help kids in your school get on their bikes. You could help to organise an event, such as a 'Wheels Day', or start a 'cycling school train' (see below). You can also become a volunteer to help more children access cycle skills training.

www.bikewise.co.nz/resources/resources-schools

www.pedalready.org.nz/become-a-volunteer/



Cycle Train

A Cycle Train is a similar concept to a Walking School bus, except on bikes. Parent volunteers supervise children as they bike to school. These parents, or 'conductors', set a route and pick up children at 'stops' along the way. Cycle trains are popular in Europe and have also been trialed in Nelson. Read the links below for more information about the Nelson study and a guideline for setting up your own school Cycle Train. The NZTA document includes a step by step guide on how to set up school Cycle Trains, surveys and consent forms to send out to parents and information about training, promotion and route selection.

Also see below for information about 'Parent and child cycle skills' courses, where parent volunteers can do cycle skills training with a focus on riding with children.

www.pinnacleresearch.co.nz/school/cycle.html

www.bit.do/cycle-trains-research

(Cycle Train Guidelines start on page 45 of the PDF)

Use of the track by the wider community

Invite the local kindergarten, pre-school, or other local schools to make use of the riding track once or twice a year. Hold bike events during weekends that are open to children from the wider community. Encourage kids to use the track during weekends and holidays.



Mountain Bike skills courses for adults

Push your own cycling skills up a notch by taking advantage of Wellington's many mountain bike tracks. JoyRide provides group and private mountain bike skills courses for adults in the Wellington region. Courses include: Intro to MTB, Turns and Berms, Rough Stuff, and Hops and drops.

www.enjoytheride.co.nz

For children's MTB courses, check out W.O.R.D. More details in 'Future Track'.

www.word.org.nz



Future Track (Activities and Events)

Everything for the school and community to get the most out of the track, including games, challenges and activities outside of school. There's also a range of events the school can host to get students and the community involved with the bike track. Here's a few ideas and links to get you started.

Games and activities

After a few weeks, kids may want – or need - to be challenged a bit more. The following are a few suggestions to get you started:

- Slow race – slowest rider wins. Rules: no feet down, no turning back or bumping into others. Tip: Use your brakes!
- Backwards days – ride the track in the 'wrong' direction – beware the seesaw! (use a monitor)
- Time trials on the skills/loop track – note times from different sessions and get kids trying to beat their personal bests. Great to see kids improve over the course of the year.
- Dismount challenge or object relay – kids have to pick up an object, either while riding or by dismounting, then drop it in or place it on a container.
- Activity stops – at certain points on the track they have to complete a task, e.g. ride with one hand, coast (no pedalling), ride while standing up on their pedals, squats on the bike, squiggles/slalom on the track, etc.
- Double up and fall back, riding in pairs in sync while completing tasks (as above)
- 'Simon says' or 'follow the leader' on bikes
- 'Easter egg', scavenger hunt or orienteering – items are hidden along the track and kids have to try spot and remember/collect as many as they can.
- Have a go at Bike Polo - using hockey sticks and a ball, kids ride around with one hand and try to get the ball into a designated area - think soccer but on bikes with sticks.

Also, check out the following resources:

- Cycling games compendium (book) www.cycletraining.co.uk/shop/
- www.kidsactivitiesblog.com/16780/outdoor-fun-bicycle-games

Wet weather outdoor activities

If the track is too wet to ride, but the kids still want some bike time outside, try these activities which can be played on a court:

- Slow race (see rules above)
- Box dodge game – all riders moving inside the box (set up cones

to make a designated box area), last one 'standing' (riding) wins. Rules: no going outside the box, crashing into others or putting feet down. As children get eliminated they leave the box and the box is made smaller if it's too easy for remaining riders (get the kids who are 'out' to make a line on two sides, taking a step in every 30 seconds to make the box smaller).

Tip:

try to get them going around the first cones in a way that they don't hit each other in the middle! It might take a few goes to get it right!

- Slalom course – start with an easy slalom and slowly move the cones closer or get them riding around the cones in pairs (side by side). Once they manage that, move the cones into a zigzag and make them go around the outside. Or have a slalom 'joust' – two children approach each other from opposite ends and have to weave around each other
- Follow the leader or Simon Says on the court
- Figure 8 – kids ride in a figure 8 formation, crossing paths in the middle. A teacher will need to take control in the middle to begin with. Riders alternate who goes so they cross paths. Great for building awareness of what's around them. And much harder than it sounds!
- Try a game of 'Rob the Nest' on bikes, or any other games played on foot. It may be chaos, or great fun!
- Grandmas footsteps on bikes
- Bike Polo

Awards Programme

Encourage students to push themselves through an awards programme. An annual "Young cyclist of the year" or a Year specific cyclist (e.g. "Year 3 cyclist of the term") award. Each class can have a vote for most improved cyclist of the term, or most helpful or any other categories that they choose.

Extra-curricular activities

Whether its family fun rides, more advanced riding or school holiday programmes, there's something here for everyone.

- The Wellington region is home to a huge array of tracks and parks designed or adapted for bikes. Check out some of the options below:
  - Greater Wellington Region bike tracks (try beginner or easy gradients unless you're already a confident mountain biker) www.gw.govt.nz/Mountain-biking-2
  - Family friendly bike rides: www.bit.do/family-rides
  - Avalon Park Bike Course – a replica 'road' with stop signs and speed bumps. (Taita Drive and Fairway Drive, Lower Hutt)
  - More suggestions here: www.bit.do/kids-rides
  - Wairarapa: www.wairarapabike.org.nz/ride/
- MTB (Mountain biking):
  - W.O.R.D. (Wellington Off-Road Riding Department) provides youth mountain biking adventures for kids 7-17 years old, including after-school programmes and holiday camps.

    www.word.org.nz



- Miramar Track Project (pump track and kids loop): www.wmtbc.org.nz/miramartrackproject
- The South Coast Kids Track in Island Bay is open for kids of all ages to use: www.trailfund.org.nz/south-coast-kids-track/
- Wainuiomata Trail Project – The Wetland Loop is a good beginners track and near the skills area: www.wtp.org.nz/wetland-loop/
- Makara Peak has beginner-intermediate tracks. try the Koru/ Lazy Fern Loop: www.makarapeak.org
- Mt Victoria has a great kids bike skills area off Alexandra Road

- Road and track cycling:
  - Track cycling is a fun, safe way to get started from around 10 years old+. From track, you can move on to Road Cycling as your experience increases. If you are interested in track cycling, get in touch with Gary at Track Cycling: www.pnp.org.nz/juniors/junior-schools-cycling/
  - Or check out the links on Cycling New Zealand: www.bit.do/cycling-nz
  - Students can start their own group rides with support from a parent or community member. From Year 7 upwards, talk to your school sports co-ordinator about having a school cycling team. There are plenty of events available for schools to enter their teams, just like any other sport. Check out the Wellington Schools Cycling website: www.groupspaces.com/WellingtonSchoolsCycling/

- BMX:
  - Capital BMX in Karori (track under construction in 2015) www.sportsground.co.nz/capitalbmx
  - Hutt Valley Thunderbolts - www.sportsground.co.nz/hvtbmx
  - Kapiti BMX - www.kapitibmxclub.wikifoundry.com
  - Wainuiomata BMX - www.wainuiomatabmx.webs.com

Big Bike Fix Up

Once news of the track hits the school community, bikes may be dusted off which are in need of some attention. Making sure kids have a safe bike to ride should be a priority. A great way of getting the community excited about the bike track and back on their bikes is to organise a Big Bike Fix Up where families can bring bikes in to get checked out and fixed up. Collaborate with a local bike shop or mechanically minded parents to get the needed spare parts and helpers.

Alternatively, the school could host a lunchtime bike cafe, where older students can do low key repairs/maintenance on bikes, and eat lunch too.

Or the school could arrange to host some ‘fix a flat’ workshops for the older students.

www.bit.do/bikewise-schools





Photo credit: W.O.R.D.

Go By Bike Day/Wheels Day

Raise awareness of cycling as a mode of transport by encouraging students and their whanau/caregivers to bike (or scooter) to school. For more info see:

www.bit.do/bikewise-schools

Planting Day

Invite the community to join the school in a Planting Day, where you plant trees or shrubs around the track. Celebrate with a BBQ and a spin round the track!

Club Day

Invite organisers from local bike clubs to come and talk to the kids. They can take them a class at a time on the track and show them what their club does (whether it's BMX, mountain biking, track or road cycling) and what skills they might learn. Kids can express an interest and take home information or perhaps follow up with a school visit to the club/track.

Work up to a short ride or excursion locally

Talk to your School Travel Planner for ideas and advice on rides that the school could do with large groups of children. Popular excursions include:

- Hutt River Trail
- Aotea Lagoon
- Biking to the local Pool/Park

Bicycle Rodeo

A Bike Rodeo is a fun event that lets kids practice a variety of skills on their bikes. It can involve the whole community or just the school. Check out these links for some ideas on how to organise a Bike Rodeo and what it involves:

www.bit.do/bike-rodeo

www.bit.do/bike-rodeo-2



School and Teacher Resources - Using cycling in the classroom

The following is a collection of resources that may be helpful to the school and teachers as they adapt to teaching with and using the bike track.

Curriculum Resources

- Pedal Ready has put together a list of resources for schools, which is a good place to start. It includes a bike and helmet checklist, a skill circuit and curriculum resources. They are also working on cycle skills videos (available 2016).
  - www.pedalready.org.nz/schools/resources-for-schools/
  - Bikewise also have a page of resources specifically for schools. www.bikewise.co.nz/resources/resources-schools
  - NZTA provide a curriculum resource – 'Road Safety: Everyone is a road user' www.education.nzta.govt.nz/resources/primary/road-safety
  - The Road Code for Cyclists is available free online, or in booklet form: www.bit.do/road-code
- Check out "Sam's Wild Ride" – how many hazards can you spot? What do you look out for when you're riding to work, school, the shops, the park or a friend's house?
  - www.pedalready.org.nz/sams-wild-ride/
- Create special projects around bikes. Some ideas:
  - Victoria University have a bike-powered generator that they are willing to bring out to Wellington schools. www.bit.do/bike-generator
  - Some councils or community Police Officers have speed guns available that measure traffic speeds around the school. Contact your local School Travel Planner to see if they can access one.
  - Take surveys of children's travel modes to use in maths based activities.
  - For the next school fair: design your own bike flag, helmet decor, and pedal power hero capes (chopping up high-vis vests).
- Also see the Movin'March website for activity ideas. www.movinmarch.com
- The following may also be of interest:
  - Let's Get Going Resources: www.bit.do/sport-taranaki
  - Developing a school cycling programme: www.bit.do/schools-programme

School Case Studies

- Cycling as a context for learning

Matthew Skilton, Principal at Tawhai School, says, "We're really interested in developing authentic learning opportunities for kids that they can then relate back to their writing programmes... so there's a whole lot of things you can relate it to. In terms of the moving and the actual travel - that would be our main focus. In terms of the physical nature of the cycle track, it's the authentic learning experience that you can then incorporate back into the classroom. Kids have experienced something and then they can relate to that more than if they've just seen it on a TV or read about it in a book."

- Watch the Movin'March video to see how cycling, bike tracks and travel to school can be incorporated into classroom learning: www.movinmarch.com

Further reading

Greater Wellington 'Getting to School' and cycling resources: www.gw.govt.nz/getting-to-school

www.gw.govt.nz/cycling

Bikes in Schools website: www.bikeon.org.nz

Bikes in Schools on Youtube: www.bit.do/BIS-videos

Harbour Sport's Toolkit for Implementing a Bikes in Schools Project: www.bit.do/BIS-guide

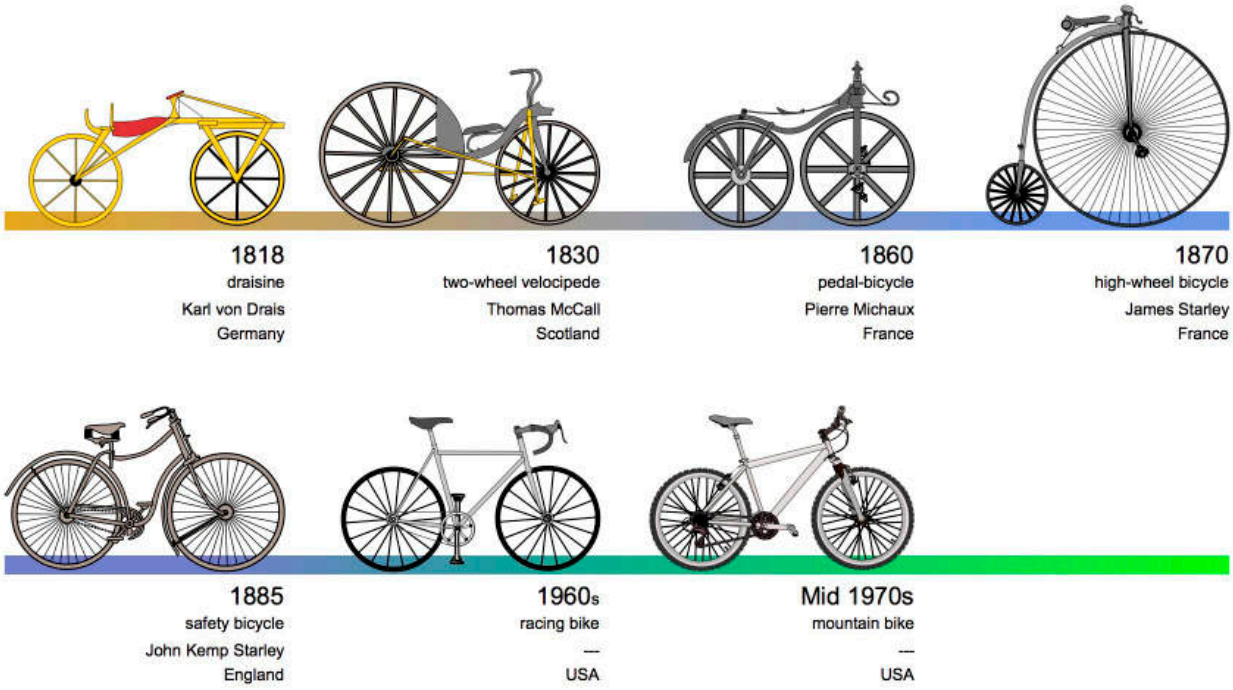
Bikewise Factsheets: www.bikewise.co.nz/media/fact-sheets

Appendices

1. Helmet fitting guide - Consumer Guide
   www.consumer.org.nz/articles/childrens-bike-helmets
2. Bikewise Seven Point Safety Check: www.bit.do/bikewise-check
3. Basic Bike Maintenance
4. Seat height adjustment guide
5. Pedal Ready Legal Requirements
6. Notice to parents - after completion of grade 2 cycle skills
7. Bikewise "Biking to School Safely" guide
   www.bit.do/bike-safety



Appendix 1: Consumer Guide to Bike Helmets



Evolution of the Bicycle across ages, with year, bicycle name, inventor, and country. By Al2 (Own work) [GFDL (http://www.gnu.org/copyleft/fdl.html) or CC BY 3.0 (http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0)], via Wikimedia Commons

The Consumer guide to Bike helmets

consumer
Making decisions easy

Wearing a good quality, well-fitted bike helmet can save you from serious injury or even death. By law, only helmets that meet the appropriate standards can be used on the road here. That means all helmets will pass a minimum safety test, and any helmet will do its job as long as it is undamaged and fits properly.

The most important thing is the FIT. Unless your helmet is fitted and worn properly, it won't give you good protection and may even do more harm than good in a crash.



How to get the RIGHT fit



Most helmets have the size range they will fit (in centimetres) on the box or the label. Get someone to **measure your head** with a tape measure and then try on a few helmets in your size. Everyone has different-shaped heads, and you'll probably find one brand or model of helmet fits better than the others.



To see if a helmet fits properly, put it on and adjust the fitting at the back so that it is snug on your head. **It should sit flat and two finger widths above your eyebrows**, and shouldn't have any areas that dig into your head or are uncomfortable.



Before you do up the straps, try to tip it and rotate it on your head. **Your scalp should move as you move the helmet**. If the helmet tips sideways, backwards or forwards, it's not a good fit.



Sizing pads are for fine tuning and comfort, not to make a big helmet smaller.



Next make sure the straps fit properly. The straps should **run in straight lines from the rim**, with the rear strap and front strap meeting just below and to the front of the earlobe. Adjust the buckle so that the strap is **firm but not tight** under your chin, and not sitting over your jawbone.

6 Things you should NEVER DO!



1 Never wear a cap under your helmet. This ruins the proper fit. In an accident, the helmet may not stay on. If you want sun protection, buy a helmet with a visor.

2 Never buy a helmet to "grow into". The accident won't wait till the helmet fits.

3 Never wear a helmet with the straps loose. It won't stay in place, and it could catch and strangle you.

4 Never wear the helmet on the back of your head. A helmet worn like this exposes your forehead and face to the road, and also means you risk being strangled by the straps in a crash.

5 Never wear a helmet after it has been in an accident or has been bashed around. Cracks in the cover, cracked or crushed foam and frayed straps all indicate it's time for a new helmet. Even if you can't see any damage, a really good whack will ruin a helmet's protective qualities. That's why kids' helmets should be replaced every couple of years.

6 Never buy a second-hand helmet. It might look OK, but you have no idea if it has been damaged.

The *right* labelling

For a bike helmet to be legal to wear on the road it must comply with one of the following standards:

AS/NZS 2063:2008, NZS 5436 or AS 2063.2	ASTM F1447-2006	EN 1078	SNELL B90 OR B95

*A label stating that the helmet meets the **US Consumer Product Safety Commission's bicycle helmet safety standard** means the helmet is also approved.*

For more information visit: www.consumer.org.nz

DISPLAY THIS POSTER!** This poster may be displayed freely in schools, retail outlets, community centres and elsewhere. Copies can be downloaded at **www.consumer.org.nz/reports/childrens-bike-helmets

Source: https://www.consumer.org.nz/articles/childrens-bike-helmets

Appendix 2: Bikewise Seven Point Safety Check

Source: https://www.bikewise.co.nz/sites/default/files/bike_wise_-_pocket_pamphlet_no_comp_1.pdf

Appendix 3: Basic Bike Maintenance links

This website has an excellent range of simple videos that cover all aspects of bike maintenance and repair:

www.madegood.org/bikes/repairs/

Auckland Transport's has a range of simple "maintenance 101" videos, here:

www.at.govt.nz/cycling-walking/cycle-safety/#videos

Also, Sheldon Brown's Bicycle Technical Info website is the 'go to' resource for detailed descriptions on how bike things work. The website is not very user-friendly, but it holds a wealth of knowledge.

www.sheldonbrown.com

Appendix 4: Bike Fit and Seat height adjustment guide

- When seated, the ball of at least one foot should touch the



ground.

  - › For riders who are learning, lower the seat so they can put both feet on the ground.
- When riding, legs should be almost straight when pedal is at the bottom of the stroke.
- A rough guide is to adjust the seat to the 'hip bone' height when the rider is standing alongside the bike. Different styles of bikes may require different height adjustments though, so see what's comfortable for the rider.
- Check that the seat post is not raised above the 'Min Insert' marking (the minimum amount that must be inserted). If not enough of the seat post is in the seat tube, it may break the top of the seat tube once the riders weight is applied. This can cause injury and damage to the bike frame.
- Always check the quick release is securely fastened before mounting the bike. Adjust using the bolt opposite the lever, and then tighten by closing the lever so that it is curved in around the post.

Appendix 5: Pedal Ready guide to Legal Requirements



Pocket sized cards available from: info@pedalready.org.nz or see also www.bit.do/bike-helmet-checklist

Appendix 6: Notice to Parents and Sample Newsletter 'biking policy'

Notice to Parents - After Completion of Grade 2 Cycle Skills

Your child has taken part in cycle skills training at . . . . . school, and has been awarded a Grade 2 certificate of participation.

This does NOT mean that your child is competent to ride safely on the road.

Basic skills covered in the course included:

- Keep to the left
- Use hand signals before turning or stopping
- Make a left or right turn safely – always check first for vehicles approaching from behind
- Ride in a straight line, no drifting into the traffic lane, or sudden changes in direction
- Check behind at regular intervals, while maintaining a straight line.
- Emergency braking
- Road rules – what to do at give way and stop signs, obey traffic signals, who has right of way
- Anticipating hazards and responding safely (parked cars, narrow road, car doors, broken glass, potholes, sumps)
- When turning right, check behind. Wait for a safe gap then signal before moving out into the lane. Wait on centre-line if necessary. Catch the eye of approaching drivers - make sure they've seen you. (A complex set of skills)

We recommend that you now spend some time riding on the road with your child, reinforcing the skills needed to interact safely with traffic.

Your child should only be given permission to ride unsupervised when you are confident that they are consistently using these skills, can maintain concentration, and have developed the necessary judgment (distance, time, speed of approaching vehicles) to judge a safe gap in traffic.

School newsletter 'biking policy':

The school policy for riding to school is that we do not wish students, under the age of 10, to be riding to school alone. Those under 10, if accompanied by a parent, may ride to school. It is at the parents' discretion to decide on a student's ability to ride safely to school. The school's Health and Safety Policy states:

- Children biking to school must wear helmets, under 10 year old children should not bike to school alone.
- All children are given a yellow safety vest to be worn at all times while travelling to and from school.

Appendix 7: Bikewise "Biking to School Safely"

Bike wise
www.bikewise.co.nz

Biking to school safely





Biking to school can be a great way for kids to get exercise, develop confidence and learn to share the road safely with motorists and other people on bikes. Before encouraging your child to get on their bike, there are a few things to consider:

Keep safe

Ensure your child has the right cycling skills to get to school safely on a bike. Always ride with your child if they're under 10 and then continue until you're sure they have the skills and confidence to ride in traffic.

Encourage your children to undertake cycle skills training so they are prepared to ride on the road. Talk to your local council about cycle skills training in your area.

The training includes the following skills:

- Turning and signalling skills away from traffic, then on quiet streets to improve traffic awareness.
- Recognising potential hazards and how to choose good places to ride.
- Riding in a straight line, at least one metre from parked cars, and using cycle lanes wherever possible.
- Watching for potential hazards including car doors, potholes, rubbish, grates and pedestrians.

The bike

Ensure your child's bike is the right size and fit. They must be able to:

- With hands on the handlebar, place the balls of both feet on the ground when sitting on the seat.
- Comfortably stand with two feet flat on the ground when straddling the centre bar.
- Easily grasp the hand brakes and apply enough pressure to stop the bike.

Bikes must have brakes and reflectors, and front and rear lights need to be on when it's dim or dark.

The helmet

Cycle helmets must be worn and meet an approved standard. Before your child sets off on their bike, ensure the helmet is securely fastened, in good condition and not cracked or damaged. Make sure it's the right size, with little or no wobble when fitted. To learn more, check out the Bike Wise Bike & Helmet Check pocket pamphlet: **www.tinyurl.com/bikehelmetcheck**





Have your child wear bright or high visibility clothing or a high-vis backpack cover and have front and rear lights for night time or low light and rain.

If an adult is cycling with young children, keep an eye out. If there's one adult, riding at the back is best. If there is more than one adult, have one at the front and one at the back.

Plan the route

Map out a safe route to school from home. Choose a way through side streets, with other kids on bikes, low traffic speeds and good visibility. Ride with your child and make sure they understand the route – have them lead to show you they know where they're going.

Sharing the road

It's important to ride with courtesy and respect for motorists and other people on bikes.

Ensure your child knows to be visible at all times, clearly show their intentions and thank other road users when they can. For example, you can show them how to let motorists or other cyclists know you're happy they've waited for you by waving, smiling, or giving them a 'thumbs up'. This will make sharing the road easier for everyone.

Try not to hold up the flow of traffic. If necessary, pull over to allow vehicles to pass.

Teach your child the road rules. Check out the Official New Zealand Code for Cyclists for more: **www.nzta.govt.nz/resources/roadcode/cyclist-code/**

Weather

Help your child check the weather conditions before each bike ride. If they are cycling in wet or low light conditions, ensure they wear high visibility and reflective clothing.

Carrying gear?

Don't hang anything from the handlebars – it could throw them off balance or get stuck in the wheels and cause a crash.

Keep healthy

Did you know 10% of all Kiwi children between two and 14 years-old are overweight and at greater risk of Type 2 diabetes, according to the Ministry of Health. Get your children into fun, healthy habits like cycling that last a lifetime.







Source: https://www.bikewise.co.nz/sites/default/files/bike_wise_cycle_school_safety_2014_0.pdf

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The Greater Wellington Regional Council's purpose is to enrich life in the Wellington Region by building resilient, connected and prosperous communities, protecting and enhancing our natural assets, and inspiring pride in what makes us unique



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